

The Generation Promised Victory and Empowerment

Chapter One: Why the Promised Generation?

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Chapter One — Why the Promised Generation?

What is happening to our Islamic ummah — from humiliation and weakness that is hidden from no one — wounds fill the body of the ummah, and weakness and frailty have struck it. The Muslims are no longer united upon the heart of a single man, nor under a single banner; rather their banners have multiplied, their directions have diverged, and their enemies have pounced upon them from every direction.

We have become the most humiliated of the people of the earth. We have no value, and our existence carries no weight. It suffices to consider what is done to us by the brothers of apes and pigs and their allies, who have placed us under their feet and subjected us to the worst of torment. They kill our children, demolish our homes, and detain our youth. All of this happens under the sight and hearing of the entire world. A bitter and agonising state in which the ummah and Islam live — so until when will this continue?

Our hope is in Allah alone.

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What further complicates the matter is that the material and technological superiority which our enemies have attained makes it difficult for us to catch up with them, while at the same time reality tells us that they will not allow us to approach them, let alone surpass them. The space they have afforded us for movement is extremely limited.

This means that material calculations confirm and establish the reality of the wretched condition which the Islamic ummah endures — nay, the situation will only worsen as a result of the boundless ambitions of global Zionism and global Crusaderism in the lands of Islam.

Yes, these are the calculations of the people of the earth. As for the calculations of the people of faith, they tell us that there is a tremendous power, the magnitude of which the human mind cannot comprehend. This power, if it supports someone — no matter how weak he may be — then victory becomes his ally, regardless of the strength of his enemies.

It is the divine power, the power of the Compeller — Glorified and Exalted be He — who possesses the hosts of the heavens and the earth, who owns everything: He owns the winds and the storms, the thunder and the lightning, the earthquakes and the volcanoes, and... He owns the very breath of our enemies.

This power is our sole hope in confronting the assaults of our savage enemies, restoring our glory, and leading humanity once again.

This power is what supported the weak among the Children of Israel against the tyrant Pharaoh and his people. So what happened?

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And We caused the people who had been oppressed to inherit the eastern regions of the land and the western ones, which We had blessed. And the good word of your Lord was fulfilled for the Children of Israel because of what they had endured. And We destroyed what Pharaoh and his people had been building and what they had been raising. (Quran, al-A'raf 7:137)

Shall We Abandon the Means?

The meaning of saying “our hope is in Allah alone” is not that we abandon material means under the claim that they are ineffective, and that our enemies will not allow us to compete with them or approach them in fields of scientific progress. Rather, the requirement is the opposite: that we fill every available space, penetrate every sector, and exert the utmost effort in acquiring the means of power — not because we will achieve victory through them, but because Allah, Mighty and Majestic, has required this of us:

And prepare against them whatever you are able of power and of cavalry to strike terror into the enemy of Allah and your enemy. (Quran, al-Anfal 8:60)

And to the extent of our effort in taking advantage of the means available to us, we will have fulfilled a condition among the conditions of victory and change — while bearing in mind that the means in and of themselves will not bring us victory. Rather, the one who will bring it is Allah. Is He not the One who says:

And victory is not but from Allah. (Quran, al-Anfal 8:10)

And the One who says:

If Allah supports you, none can overcome you; and if He forsakes you, who is it that can support you after Him? And upon Allah let the believers rely. (Quran, Al 'Imran 3:160)

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When Will the Victory of Allah Come?

If our hope is in Allah alone, then when will this hope be realised? When will Allah come to our aid, grant us victory over our enemies, and establish us on the earth?

The Quran has elaborated in answering this question, and its verses have informed us that victory and establishment have conditions, by which they are sought and brought about. Among them is His saying, Exalted be He:

Indeed, Allah will not change the condition of a people until they change what is in themselves. (Quran, al-Ra'd 13:11)

And His saying, Exalted be He:

If you support Allah, He will support you and plant firmly your feet. (Quran, Muhammad 47:7)

And His saying:

And if you are patient and fear Allah, their plotting will not harm you at all. (Quran, Al 'Imran 3:120)

So it is necessary, then, that we support Allah within ourselves, and change what is within them, and transition from every state that angers Allah, Mighty and Majestic, to the state that pleases Him.

There must be a deep change that strikes into the depths of the ummah and returns it to Allah, if we wish to emerge from the state of bewilderment in which we find ourselves.

Breathing Life

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And in order for the condition of the ummah to change from illness to health, there must be someone who takes it by the hand, guides it to the remedy, and helps it change what it has clothed itself with — that which angers Allah, Mighty and Majestic.

There must emerge a group or a generation in the midst of the ummah that breathes life and hope into it, and shows it the path of reconciliation with Allah. This is especially so because the Islamic ummah is now more prepared for this than at any other time, for its enemies have disclosed what they used to conceal of enmity, hatred, and black malice. The instruments of slaughter for our Muslim brothers are being prepared before our very eyes, and their treacherous plans to dissolve our identity are announced to us before their execution — in outright defiance of us, and to kill any hope that visits us.

Directing Sentiment

Yes, the ummah is not entirely absent of feeling; rather, there exists a surging sentiment toward Islam, growing with the passage of days. Perhaps evidence of that sentiment includes: the filling of mosques with youth and elders, the turn to Quran circles and lessons of knowledge, and among such evidence also: the spread of the hijab among Muslim women.

A genuine sentiment exists today in the breast of the ummah, but it alone is not sufficient. Rather, it must be properly directed toward the correct direction — the direction of real change of what is within the soul, encompassing several dimensions: thoughts and concerns, the secret and the open, words and actions. A change that reshapes the mind, enables faith in the heart, and drives out from it the love of

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the world. This then reflects upon behaviour through haste toward good deeds, ambition for the highest ranks in Paradise, attachment to Allah, Mighty and Majestic, and severing expectations from what is in people's hands — while exerting the utmost effort in preparation and acquiring the means of power.

This task — the task of directing sentiment to bring about real change in souls — requires immense effort, mutual commitment, and follow-through. Here comes the role of the promised generation, for it is the generation entrusted with the mission of changing the ummah, and preparing its ground to receive divine support.

Yes, it is a difficult task, and the path to achieving it will not be strewn with roses. It will confront the desires of the people, their love for the world, and their unwillingness to sacrifice even a small part of it. But with perseverance and the presence of a righteous example in the sons of the generation of change, and once assured of their sincerity, their devotion to the welfare of the ummah, and that they seek no reward for their actions — all this and more is part of the generation's mission of returning the ummah to Allah, gradually. This is especially so when the sons of the promised generation adopt the methodology of wisdom in da'wah, and present the concept of change to the people in a beloved and accessible manner that everyone can understand.

Leading the Ummah in Hardship

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To the extent of the effort that the sons of the promised generation will exert in awakening the ummah, breathing life into it, and properly directing its sentiment toward real change and reconcili-

ation with Allah — to that extent will come the support and backing from Allah, Mighty and Majestic. It will inevitably come, so that the first glimmers of dawn begin to rise, and the sun of Islam shines anew in various parts of the ummah.

So what will happen then?

History tells us that as soon as a ray of light appears, and the beginning of the giant's awakening and emergence from the darkness in which he was placed is announced, all the disbelieving forces surrounding our ummah will unite against us, and will work to extinguish this light, abort this hope, and eliminate the Islamic project.

There will be a comprehensive boycott from all sides, and pressure will increase wherever the banner of Islam is raised.

The pressure will be severe, seeking to create division within the ummah, and working to subjugate it. It is expected that this pressure will cause distress and grumbling among the masses, for even if they have declared their support for Islam and their readiness to sacrifice for it, they may not be able to bear the consequences of the boycott — such as being deprived of some of their basic needs, let alone

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their needs for comfort and perfection. Here comes the role of the promised generation, which will work diligently to provide for people's needs, breathe the spirit of hope into their souls, work to steady them, raise their morale, and bind them to Allah, Mighty and Majestic.

This means that these devoted ones will not sleep in these circumstances except after the people have slept, and will not eat until they are assured that food has reached everyone.

A dangerous role awaits this generation at the inception of the Islamic state — if it does not rise to it, everything will be lost, and matters will return to worse than they are, and Allah forbid.

With the First Generation

These stages, these difficult conditions, were experienced by the Messenger of Allah (peace be upon him) and those with him of the first generation — the generation of the foremost predecessors from the Muhajirun and Ansar, who served as the pillars upon which the Muslim community in Madinah was built. This community was subjected, at the beginning of its formation, to severe pressure, siege, boycott, threats, and wars.

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Abu al-'Aliyyah said in his tafsir of His saying, Exalted be He:

Allah has promised those who have believed among you and done righteous deeds that He will surely grant them succession to authority upon the earth, just as He granted it to those before them, and that He will surely establish for them their religion which He has preferred for them, and that He will surely substitute for them, after their fear, security — as they worship Me, not associating anything with Me. And whoever disbelieves after that — then it is those who are the defiantly disobedient. (Quran, al-Nur 24:55)

He said: The Prophet (peace be upon him) and his companions were in Mecca for about ten years, calling to Allah alone, and to the worship of Him alone, with no partner — secretly, in fear, not commanded to fight, until they were commanded to emigrate to Madinah. They did so, and then Allah commanded them to fight. They were in fear — they would spend the night in weapons and rise

in the morning in weapons. They bore this, by Allah's will. Then a man from among the Companions said:

"O Messenger of Allah... will we remain in fear like this forever?! Will a day not come upon us when we can be secure and put down our weapons?!"

The Messenger of Allah (peace be upon him) said: "You will not have to wait long before a man among you will sit in the great gathering, leaning on his couch, with no weapon on him." And Allah revealed this verse, and Allah established His Prophet over the Arabian Peninsula, and they became secure and put down their weapons.

And al-Bara' ibn 'Azib said: "This verse was revealed while we were in severe fear."(1)

Why Hardship?

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So there is a harsh period through which the ummah will pass, especially in the places where the banner of Islam will be raised.

If you say: But why will the rising ummah pass through this period? And why will it be left to this tremendous tribulation while it stands alone before the entire world?

The answer would be in His saying, Exalted be He:

Do the people think that they will be left to say, "We believe," and they will not be tried? And We have certainly tested those before them, so Allah will surely know those who are truthful, and He will surely know those who are liars. (Quran, al-Ankabut 29:1-3)

This period serves as a test of the ummah's sincerity in its love for Allah, its attachment to Him, and its reliance upon Him — and the extent of its readiness to sacrifice for His sake. It is the period of the final crucible for the birth of the young, strong ummah.

Among its benefits, also, is that it severs the attachment of hearts to anything other than Allah, and strips them for Him alone, Glorified be He. When material means are cut off, patience is exhausted, and calamities intensify, the ummah finds nothing before it except Allah, Mighty and Majestic — so it rushes to Him and calls upon Him with the call of the desperate, overwhelmed by drowning. Then relief comes, and victory and establishment arrive:

Or do you think that you will enter Paradise while such trial has not yet come to you as came to those who passed before you? They were touched by misery and hardship and were shaken until even the Messenger and those who believed with him said, "When is the help of Allah?" Unquestionably, the help of Allah is near. (Quran, al-Baqarah 2:214)

Leading the Ummah in Prosperity

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And after the period of hardship and trials, relief will come — by Allah's permission — and the ummah will begin to unite, gradually. The banners of falsehood will fall with ease and speed. Here, the generation of change will assume a new role: working to unite the ummah under a single banner, leading it to establish the Islamic caliphate, recovering all occupied lands, and rescuing oppressed Muslims in every corner of the earth.

And the role of the promised generation will continue after that in spreading Islam and achieving global leadership, and realising the promise of the Messenger of Allah (peace be upon him) that this religion will reach the horizons, and that Rome will be conquered, so that the Islamic state thereby

becomes the foremost power in the world — spreading security and safety, rescuing humanity from misguidance, and bringing it out of darkness into light.

Yes, this will happen — by Allah’s permission — just as it happened with the first generation, who began as individuals — persecuted, oppressed in Mecca — reading the Quran and listening to the verses of the promise of victory and establishment. Their utmost aspiration at that time was to sleep securely, and that no one among them would be exposed to harm. These very people saw establishment with their own eyes, and witnessed the might and glory of Islam. And how wondrous that after this, their fear became for themselves — the fear of the trial of the world being spread out before them.

Al-Bukhari reported in his Sahih that ‘Abd al-Rahman ibn ‘Awf — may Allah be pleased with him — was brought food while he was fasting. He said:

“Mus’ab ibn ‘Umayr was killed, and he was better than me. He was shrouded in a single garment: if his head was covered, his feet were exposed, and if his feet were covered,

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his head was exposed. And Hamzah was killed, and he was better than me. Then the world was spread out before us,” or he said: “We were given of the world, and we fear that our good deeds have been hastened to us as reward.” Then he wept until he abandoned the food.

And this is Khabbab ibn al-Aratt — may Allah be pleased with him — who was visiting a group of the Companions of the Prophet (peace be upon him). They said to him: “Rejoice, O ‘Abdullah, for your brothers will be raised on the Day of Judgment as martyrs.” He wept and said:

“I am not anxious about death, but you have reminded me of people, and you have called them my brothers, and those have indeed departed having received their wages in full. I fear that the reward of the deeds you mention may be what we have been given after them.”(2)

Drawing Lessons from the Past

Upon the generation of change is the duty not to abandon its mission of leading the ummah, even after it attains sovereignty and global leadership. Rather, it must continue building generations, and guarding them against the diseases of nations — such as luxury, oppression, and then distance from Allah, Mighty and Majestic, and departure from the circle of His command and His guardianship.

Summary

The ummah’s need now for the existence of the generation of change — the promised generation of victory and establishment — is a severe and agonising need that demands the pooling of all efforts for its formation. And why not, when it is the generation that will breathe life into the ummah

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— by Allah’s permission — and direct its sentiment in a correct direction toward real change. The generation of change will continue leading the ummah through the period of hardship, anguish, and the expected boycott from the enemies of Islam, and will likewise continue through the period of prosperity, conquests, the caliphate, and global leadership. It will not put down its weapons or lean to comfort after that; rather, it will continue building generations, preserving glory and honour, and working to spread the true religion in every place.

Footnotes

(1) Tafsir al-Qur'an al-'Azim by al-Hafiz Ibn Kathir 3/283, Maktabat al-'Abikan, Riyadh.

(2) Hayat al-Sahabah by Muhammad Yusuf al-Kandhlawi 1/100–101, Dar Sadir, Beirut.

Quranic Verses Cited in This Chapter

#	Reference	Surah	Page	Topic
1	7:137	al-A'raf	12	Inheritance of the earth by the oppressed
2	8:60	al-Anfal	12	Prepare against them what you can of power
3	8:10	al-Anfal	12	Victory is not but from Allah
4	3:160	Al 'Imran	12	If Allah supports you, none can overcome you
5	13:11	al-Ra'd	13	Allah does not change a people until they change
6	47:7	Muhammad	13	If you support Allah, He will support you
7	3:120	Al 'Imran	13	Patience and taqwa neutralise plotting
8	24:55	al-Nur	18	The promise of succession and establishment
9	29:1–3	al-'Ankabut	19	People will be tested — the truthful from the liars
10	2:214	al-Baqarah	19	Before victory comes shaking and hardship

Hadith and Companion Narrations in This Chapter

#	Narration	Source	Page
1	A companion asks the Prophet: “Will we remain in fear forever?” — the Prophet promises security	Tafsir Ibn Kathir 3/283	18
2	Al-Bara' ibn 'Azib: “This verse was revealed while we were in severe fear” (regarding 24:55)	Tafsir Ibn Kathir 3/283	18

#	Narration	Source	Page
3	'Abd al-Rahman ibn 'Awf weeps while fasting, remembering martyred companions (Mus'ab ibn 'Umayr and Hamzah)	Sahih al-Bukhari	20–21
4	Khabbab ibn al-Aratt weeps, fearing worldly reward may replace eternal reward	Hayat al-Sahabah 1/100–101	21

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Translated from the Arabic original. All Quranic verses cited with surah name and chapter:verse reference. All hadith narrations cited with source. No Arabic script included in this translation as per reader request.